

FIELD GUIDE

Forward- Deployed Engineering.

The title is new. The work is ten years old.

Swipe >>>

WHAT IT IS

Ship next to the problem.

Forward-deployed is not a build you hand over. You sit where the thing fails, and you fix it there. I have shipped production systems this way, solo.

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THE MOTION · 01

Understand the real problem

Not the tidy version in the ticket. The system nobody documented, and the edge cases the user actually lives in.

Build for the failure case

The demo always works. Production is the repair queue. My own agent fleet once overflowed its context window mid-run before I built for what breaks first.

Deploy, then fix at the edge

Watch it fail with real users. Fix it close to where it broke. Then do it again, faster.

THE RECEIPTS

I've shipped this solo.

A content pipeline that runs itself. A finance app on a real backend. A fleet of AI agents wired to scheduled jobs and tool integrations. Each one a fuzzy ask, now running in production.

THE TAKEAWAY

**The title is new.
The discipline
is not.**

What broke first the last time you put
something live?

◆ Follow Joseph Bankole for field notes